

Retail and E-Commerce English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: retail managers, e-commerce teams, merchandising staff, store operations leaders, fulfillment teams, customer service managers, marketplace sellers, and growth operators

Focus: A retail and e-commerce English curriculum for merchandising, pricing, inventory, fulfillment, marketplaces, customer complaints, returns, conversion metrics, promotions, and vendor coordination.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Merchandising and Assortment Planning

Situation

A buyer wants to add many new SKUs before holiday season.

Stakeholder pressure: Approve the assortment expansion.

Constraint: Shelf space, demand signal, margin, inventory risk, and vendor capacity need review.

Terms to use

- assortment
- SKU
- sell-through
- gross margin

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A buyer wants to add many new SKUs before holiday season.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Approve the assortment expansion.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm assortment, SKU, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	fulfillment delay script
B	conversion diagnosis
C	assortment decision memo
D	replenishment action plan

Module 2. Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

Situation

A promotion drives revenue but margin falls sharply.

Stakeholder pressure: Repeat the promotion because sales increased.

Constraint: Gross margin, cannibalization, inventory, customer acquisition, and brand impact matter.

Terms to use

- markdown
- promotion
- gross margin
- cannibalization

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A promotion drives revenue but margin falls sharply.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Repeat the promotion because sales increased.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm markdown, promotion, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	control
B	disclosure
C	promotion readout
D	approval

Module 3. Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment**Situation**

A hot item is stocked out in stores but overstocked online.

Stakeholder pressure: Transfer everything immediately.

Constraint: Allocation, demand, lead time, logistics cost, and service level require planning.

Terms to use

- allocation
- replenishment
- stockout

- inventory turn

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A hot item is stocked out in stores but overstocked online.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Transfer everything immediately.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm allocation, replenishment, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	replenishment action plan
B	disclosure
C	assortment decision memo
D	promotion readout

Module 4. Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

Situation

A warehouse backlog delays guaranteed delivery dates.

Stakeholder pressure: Send a general apology.

Constraint: Order status, carrier capacity, customer promise, refund policy, and service recovery matter.

Terms to use

- fulfillment
- SLA
- return rate
- carrier

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A warehouse backlog delays guaranteed delivery dates.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Send a general apology.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm fulfillment, SLA, the owner, and the evidence standard.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	fulfillment delay script
B	timeline
C	assumption
D	mitigation

Module 5. Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

Situation

Checkout conversion drops after a redesign.

Stakeholder pressure: Assume customers dislike the new look.

Constraint: Instrumentation, device mix, payment errors, and funnel step drop-off need analysis.

Terms to use

- conversion rate
- funnel
- cart abandonment
- A/B test

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

Checkout conversion drops after a redesign.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Assume customers dislike the new look.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm conversion rate, funnel, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	mitigation
B	conversion diagnosis
C	timeline

Option	Phrase
D	assumption

Module 6. Marketplace and Vendor Management

Situation

A vendor ships late and product ratings fall.

Stakeholder pressure: Threaten to delist them immediately.

Constraint: Scorecards, SLA, customer impact, inventory, and remediation plan need review.

Terms to use

- marketplace
- vendor scorecard
- SLA
- defect rate

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A vendor ships late and product ratings fall.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Threaten to delist them immediately.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm marketplace, vendor scorecard, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	evidence
B	risk
C	vendor scorecard update
D	omnichannel operations brief

Module 7. Customer Service and Escalations

Situation

A customer demands a refund outside the return window.

Stakeholder pressure: Make an exception for anyone who complains loudly.

Constraint: Policy, goodwill, fraud risk, and customer lifetime value need balanced judgment.

Terms to use

- return policy
- goodwill credit
- chargeback
- customer lifetime value

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A customer demands a refund outside the return window.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Make an exception for anyone who complains loudly.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm return policy, goodwill credit, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	replenishment action plan
B	fulfillment delay script
C	escalation response
D	promotion readout

Module 8. Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution**Situation**

Buy-online-pickup-in-store orders are not ready on time.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell stores to prioritize online orders over walk-ins.

Constraint: Labor, inventory accuracy, queue management, and customer expectations all matter.

Terms to use

- BOPIS
- inventory accuracy
- queue
- labor model

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

Buy-online-pickup-in-store orders are not ready on time.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell stores to prioritize online orders over walk-ins.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm BOPIS, inventory accuracy, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	omnichannel operations brief
B	mitigation
C	approval
D	control

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each answer after completing the dialogue. The rationale shows why the correct phrase is the strongest fit for the real workplace situation.

Merchandising and Assortment Planning

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. assortment decision memo	A assortment decision memo is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. promotion readout	A promotion readout is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. replenishment action plan	A replenishment action plan is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. fulfillment delay script	A fulfillment delay script is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. conversion diagnosis	A conversion diagnosis is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Marketplace and Vendor Management

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. vendor scorecard update	A vendor scorecard update is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Customer Service and Escalations

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. escalation response	A escalation response is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. omnichannel operations brief	A omnichannel operations brief is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.